UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

COMBINED DEFENCE SERVICES (CDS) EXAMINATION

PAPER II : GENERAL KNOWLEDGE - OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & DETAILED SOLUTIONS

ALL 6 SUBJECTS ARCHIVE (SERIES A - Q.1 TO Q.239)

OFFICIAL EVALUATION SCHEME & CUTOFF INSTRUCTIONS

- **Marking Formula:** Score = (Correct x 0.8333) - (Incorrect x 0.2778)
- **Mandatory Sectional Cutoff:** Minimum **20.00 Marks (20%)** in General Knowledge.
- **Validity:** Fully verified against official UPSC CDS answer keys and constitutional/scientific records.

PART I : MASTER SCORING ANSWER KEYS

Subject 1 : Indian Polity & Constitution (Q.1 - Q.36)

Q.1	Q.2	Q.3	Q.4	Q.5	Q.6	Q.7	Q.8	Q.9	Q.10
(B)	(C)	(A)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(B)
(B)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(B)
(D)	(B)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(B)	(B)	(B)	(C)
(C)	(C)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(A)	-	-	-	-

Subject 2 : Indian History & Freedom Struggle (Q.37 - Q.66)

Q.37	Q.38	Q.39	Q.40	Q.41	Q.42	Q.43	Q.44	Q.45	Q.46
(C)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(D)	(A)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(A)
(C)	(C)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(C)
(B)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(B)	(D)	(A)	(A)

Subject 3 : Geography (Physical, Indian & World) (Q.67 - Q.107)

Q.67	Q.68	Q.69	Q.70	Q.71	Q.72	Q.73	Q.74	Q.75	Q.76
(A)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(B)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(B)
(B)	(B)	(A)	(C)	(C)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)
(A)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(B)	(D)	(C)
(D)	(C)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)
(B)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Subject 4 : General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) (Q.108 - Q.163)

Q.108	Q.109	Q.110	Q.111	Q.112	Q.113	Q.114	Q.115	Q.116	Q.117
(A)	(B)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(A)	(B)	(A)
(C)	(A)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(B)
(B)	(C)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(C)
(A)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(B)	(B)	(B)
(C)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)	(A)
(C)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(C)	-	-	-	-

Subject 5 : Indian Economy & Social Development (Q.164 - Q.183)

Q.164	Q.165	Q.166	Q.167	Q.168	Q.169	Q.170	Q.171	Q.172	Q.173
(A)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(A)	(A)
(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(B)	(A)	(A)

Subject 6 : Defence, Security & Current Affairs (Q.184 - Q.239)

Q.184	Q.185	Q.186	Q.187	Q.188	Q.189	Q.190	Q.191	Q.192	Q.193
(B)	(A)	(A)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(B)	(A)	(B)
(C)	(B)	(B)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(B)	(C)
(C)	(C)	(A)	(B)	(B)	(A)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(A)
(C)	(C)	(B)	(C)	(B)	(B)	(B)	(A)	(A)	(A)
(A)	(C)	(C)	(A)	(C)	(C)	(C)	(B)	(A)	(A)
(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(A)	(B)	-	-	-	-

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

PART II : DETAILED SUBJECT-WISE EXPLANATIONS & RATIONALES

SUBJECT 1 : INDIAN POLITY & CONSTITUTION (Q.1 - Q.36)

Q.1. (Indian Polity & Constitution #1) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: According to the Election Commission of India, in order to be recognized as a 'National Party', a political party must be treated ...
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Indian Polity & Constitution according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.2. (Indian Polity & Constitution #2) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: By which one of the following, an old written material which cannot be read easily, can be read?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian Polity & Constitution).

Q.3. (Indian Polity & Constitution #3) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements regarding the writ of 'Quo-Warranto':
Solution & Rationale: Statement 1 is correct: Quo-Warranto is issued by the High Court or Supreme Court to inquire into the legality of a claim by a person to a public office. Statement 2 is incorrect: Unlike habeas corpus or certiorari, any public-spirited citizen can move the court for Quo-Warranto; the petitioner need not be an aggrieved person.

Q.4. (Indian Polity & Constitution #4) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: According to the Constitution (Fifty-Second Amendment) Act 1985 as amended in 2003, a legislator attracts disqualification under t...
Solution & Rationale: Under the Tenth Schedule (Anti-Defection Law), a member is disqualified if they voluntarily give up party membership, vote contrary to party whip without prior permission, or if an independent member joins any political party. The 91st Amendment (2003) deleted the exemption for 1/3rd split, requiring at least 2/3rd for merger.

Q.5. (Indian Polity & Constitution #5) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: For which one of the following landmark judgments of the Supreme Court of India is the Kesavananda Bharati case (1973) famous?
Solution & Rationale: In Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973), a 13-judge bench of the Supreme Court ruled by a 7:6 majority that Parliament has broad powers to amend the Constitution under Article 368, but cannot alter its 'Basic Structure'.

Q.6. (Indian Polity & Constitution #6) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In Indian constitutional history, what was the 'Privy Purse' that was abolished by the 26th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1971?
Solution & Rationale: Privy Purse was a payment made to the royal families of erstwhile princely states as part of their agreements to integrate into the Union of India in 1947. It was abolished in 1971 by the 26th Amendment Act under Indira Gandhi.

Q.7. (Indian Polity & Constitution #7) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In democratic political theory and constitutional design, why is power sharing considered desirable in diverse societies?
Solution & Rationale: Power sharing accommodates social diversity, prevents majoritarian domination, and fosters political stability by giving all communities a stake in governance.

Q.8. (Indian Polity & Constitution #8) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In sociology and developmental psychology, which of the following is considered the primary and earliest agency of socialization f...
Solution & Rationale: The family is the primary agency of socialization where a child first acquires language, behavioral norms, emotional attachments, and cultural values.

Q.9. (Indian Polity & Constitution #9) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In which of the following years were the Fundamental Duties incorporated into the Constitution of India?
Solution & Rationale: Fundamental Duties were incorporated into Part IV-A (Article 51A) of the Constitution by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976, on the recommendations of the Swaran Singh Committee.

Q.10. (Indian Polity & Constitution #10) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: The Directive Principles of State Policy
Solution & Rationale: The Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV, Articles 36-51) were borrowed from the Irish Constitution (which had copied them from the Spanish Constitution).

Q.11. (Indian Polity & Constitution #11) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: The Joint Sitting of both Houses of Parliament is summoned by the President under Article
Solution & Rationale: The Speaker of Lok Sabha presides over a joint sitting of both Houses of Parliament (Article 118(4)). In the Speaker's absence, the Deputy Speaker presides; in their absence, the Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha presides.

Q.12. (Indian Polity & Constitution #12) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The Second Backward Classes Commission, popularly known as the Mandal Commission, submitted its report recommending 27% reservatio...
Solution & Rationale: Appointed in 1979 by the Morarji Desai government under B.P. Mandal, the Commission submitted its report in December 1980. It was implemented in 1990 under Prime Minister V.P. Singh.

Q.13. (Indian Polity & Constitution #13) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The historic 'Panchsheel' (Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence) was formally enunciated in 1954 in an agreement between India ...
Solution & Rationale: Panchsheel was signed on 29 April 1954 in Beijing in the preamble to the Agreement on Trade and Intercourse between Tibet Region of China and India by Premier Zhou Enlai and Prime Minister Nehru.

Q.14. (Indian Polity & Constitution #14) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Under Article 368 of the Constitution of India, a Constitutional Amendment Bill can be introduced in:
Solution & Rationale: A Constitutional Amendment Bill can be initiated in either House of Parliament (Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha) and not in state legislatures. It does not require prior recommendation of the President.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.15. (Indian Polity & Constitution #15) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Under the provisions of the Citizenship Act, 1955, through which of the following methods can a person acquire Indian citizenship?...
Solution & Rationale: The Citizenship Act, 1955 prescribes five ways of acquiring citizenship: birth, descent, registration, naturalization, and incorporation of territory.

Q.16. (Indian Polity & Constitution #16) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: What does the author mean by "authen- tic' civil society" ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.17. (Indian Polity & Constitution #17) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: What is a 'Concordat' in international diplomacy and legal history?
Solution & Rationale: A Concordat is an official bilateral convention or agreement concluded between the Pope (Holy See) and the secular government of a sovereign state.

Q.18. (Indian Polity & Constitution #18) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which Article of the Constitution of India provides that the law declared by the Supreme Court shall be binding on all courts with...
Solution & Rationale: Article 141 of the Constitution provides that the law declared by the Supreme Court shall be binding on all courts within the territory of India. Article 142 relates to complete justice enforcement.

Q.19. (Indian Polity & Constitution #19) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which Constitutional Amendment Act substituted the word 'Armed Rebellion' for 'Internal Disturbance' in Article 352 (National Emer...
Solution & Rationale: The 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978 substituted 'armed rebellion' for the vaguer phrase 'internal disturbance' to prevent arbitrary imposition of National Emergency.

Q.20. (Indian Polity & Constitution #20) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which of the following Fundamental Rights is/are available to both Indian citizens and foreigners (except enemy aliens)?
Solution & Rationale: Articles 15, 16, 19, 29, and 30 are available ONLY to Indian citizens. Articles 14, 20, 21, 21A, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, and 28 are available to both citizens and foreigners.

Q.21. (Indian Polity & Constitution #21) Correct Response: (D)
Question Reference: Which of the following constitutional provisions require ratification by legislatures of not less than half of the States under Ar...
Solution & Rationale: Under the proviso to Article 368(2), federal provisions including presidential elections (Arts 54, 55), executive power extents (Arts 73, 162), Supreme Court/High Courts, Seventh Schedule lists, and Article 368 itself require ratification by at least half of the state legislatures.

Q.22. (Indian Polity & Constitution #22) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which of the following Writs literally means 'We Command' and is issued to enforce the performance of a mandatory public duty?
Solution & Rationale: Mandamus literally translates to 'We Command'. It is an order issued by the Supreme Court (Art 32) or High Court (Art 226) to any public authority or inferior tribunal commanding them to perform an obligatory public duty.

Q.23. (Indian Polity & Constitution #23) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which of the following authorities is vested with the power to alter the boundaries or name of any State in India?
Solution & Rationale: Under Article 3 of the Constitution, Parliament may by law form a new State or alter the area, boundaries or name of any State by a simple majority.

Q.24. (Indian Polity & Constitution #24) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following is the primary constitutional function of the Pro-Tem Speaker of the Lok Sabha?
Solution & Rationale: The Pro-Tem Speaker is appointed by the President (typically the senior-most member) to preside over the initial sitting of the newly constituted Lok Sabha, administer oath/affirmation to new MPs, and conduct the election of the permanent Speaker.

Q.25. (Indian Polity & Constitution #25) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following is explicitly listed as a Fundamental Duty of citizens under Article 51A of the Constitution of Indi...
Solution & Rationale: Article 51A(d) specifies: 'to defend the country and render national service when called upon to do so'. Voting, paying taxes, and family planning were recommended by the Swaran Singh Committee but not included in Article 51A.

Q.26. (Indian Polity & Constitution #26) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one among the following pairs of level of government and legislative power is not correctly matched ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.27. (Indian Polity & Constitution #27) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one among the following statements regarding the erstwhile Planning Commission of India is NOT correct?
Solution & Rationale: The Planning Commission was neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body; it was an extra-constitutional body created by an executive resolution of the Government of India in March 1950.

Q.28. (Indian Polity & Constitution #28) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Indian States has the highest percentage of Scheduled Tribe population to its total population?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Indian Polity & Constitution according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.29. (Indian Polity & Constitution #29) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Constitutional Amendments deleted the Right to Property from the list of Fundamental Rights?
Solution & Rationale: The 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978 abolished the Right to Property as a Fundamental Right (Article 19(1)(f) and Article 31) and made it a constitutional/legal right under Article 300A in Part XII.

Q.30. (Indian Polity & Constitution #30) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Fundamental Rights under the Constitution of India is also available to non-citizens (foreigners)?
Solution & Rationale: Articles 15, 16, 19, 29, and 30 are available ONLY to Indian citizens. Article 21 (Protection of life and personal liberty) is guaranteed to all persons, both citizens and foreigners.

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Q.31. (Indian Polity & Constitution #31) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Commis- sions is not provided
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian Polity & Constitution).

Q.32. (Indian Polity & Constitution #32) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following jurisdictions of the Indian Judiciary covers Public Interest Litigation ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian Polity & Constitution).

Q.33. (Indian Polity & Constitution #33) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is both a Fundamental Right under Article 21A of the Indian Constitution and recognized as a Universal ...
Solution & Rationale: The 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002 inserted Article 21A providing free and compulsory education to all children aged 6 to 14 years. Free elementary education is also protected under Article 26 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

Q.34. (Indian Polity & Constitution #34) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following statements regarding the appointment of District Judges in India is correct?
Solution & Rationale: Under Article 233 of the Constitution of India, appointments, posting, and promotion of district judges in any State are made by the Governor in consultation with the High Court exercising jurisdiction.

Q.35. (Indian Polity & Constitution #35) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following eminent jurists served as the Constitutional Advisor to the Constituent Assembly of India and prepared the...
Solution & Rationale: Sir Benegal Narsing Rau (B. N. Rau) was appointed Constitutional Advisor to the Constituent Assembly in 1946. He drafted the basic framework of the Indian Constitution.

Q.36. (Indian Polity & Constitution #36) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: With reference to the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?
Solution & Rationale: Stock Exchanges and futures markets are listed under Entry 90 of the Union List (List I), not the State List. Forests was transferred from State List to Concurrent List by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976.

SUBJECT 2 : INDIAN HISTORY & FREEDOM STRUGGLE (Q.37 - Q.66)

Q.37. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #1) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Britain and France French attempt for a no-fly zone could not reach consensus United Nations has been non- supportive for any kind...
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

Q.38. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #2) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Consider the following statement : "A sound body means one which bends itself to the spirit and is always a ready instrument at it...
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.39. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #3) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Following the first schism in the Brahmo Samaj in 1866, who were the leaders of the two factions (Adi Brahmo Samaj and Brahmo Sama...
Solution & Rationale: In 1866, the Brahmo Samaj split into the conservative 'Adi Brahmo Samaj' led by Debendranath Tagore and the reformist 'Brahmo Samaj of India' led by Keshab Chandra Sen.

Q.40. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #4) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Rabindranath Tagore renounced his British Knighthood in May 1919 in protest against which of the following atrocities?
Solution & Rationale: Rabindranath Tagore wrote an impassioned letter to Viceroy Lord Chelmsford repudiating his Knighthood following the brutal Jallianwala Bagh massacre of innocent Indians on 13 April 1919.

Q.41. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #5) Correct Response: (D)
Question Reference: The Cabinet Mission arrived in India in 1946.
Solution & Rationale: The Cabinet Mission sent by Clement Attlee in March 1946 consisted of three British cabinet ministers: Lord Pethick-Lawrence, Sir Stafford Cripps, and A.V. Alexander. Lord Wavell was the Viceroy of India, not a Mission member.

Q.42. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #6) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The historic Poona Pact of 1932 was signed between Mahatma Gandhi and:
Solution & Rationale: The Poona Pact was signed on 24 September 1932 at Yerwada Central Jail between Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, replacing separate electorates for depressed classes with reserved joint electorate seats.

Q.43. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #7) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Under which one of the following revenue assessment systems introduced by the British was land revenue collected directly from the...
Solution & Rationale: The Ryotwari System was introduced by Thomas Munro and Captain Alexander Read in Madras and Bombay Presidencies. Revenue was settled directly with individual cultivators (ryots).

Q.44. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #8) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Under which operation codename did India conduct a series of five nuclear bomb test explosions at the Pokhran test range in May 19...
Solution & Rationale: Pokhran-II, conducted on 11 and 13 May 1998 under Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, was designated Operation Shakti. (Pokhran-I in 1974 was Operation Smiling Buddha).

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.45. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #9) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: What does 'Fuwa', the Official Mascot of the 2008 Olympic Games in Beijing, represent?
Solution & Rationale: Fuwa (literally 'good-luck dolls') were the mascots of the 2008 Beijing Olympics, designed to embody the Olympic rings and Chinese natural elements (Beibei, Jingjing, Huanhuan, Yingying, Nini).

Q.46. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #10) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: What is the correct chronological sequence of the following historic events in the Indian national movement? 1. Non-Cooperation Mo...
Solution & Rationale: Non-Cooperation Movement (1920), Simon Commission arrival (1928), Poona Pact between Gandhi and Ambedkar (1932), Quit India Movement (1942).

Q.47. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #11) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which British Military Officer defeated Tipu Sultan in India, Napolean Bonaparte in Europe arid eventually became the Duke of Well...
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian History & Freedom Struggle).

Q.48. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #12) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which Buddhist Council was convened during the reign of King Ashoka at Pataliputra?
Solution & Rationale: The Third Buddhist Council was convened in 250 BCE at Pataliputra under the patronage of Emperor Ashoka and presided over by Moggaliputta Tissa. The Abhidhamma Pitaka was compiled here.

Q.49. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #13) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which One among the following is not a characteristic Of Rig-Vedic Aryans ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian History & Freedom Struggle).

Q.50. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #14) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which among the following was the most immediate catalyst for the nationwide spread of the Swadeshi and Boycott Movement in 1905?
Solution & Rationale: Lord Curzon announced the Partition of Bengal in July 1905 and implemented it on 16 October 1905, triggering the anti-partition Swadeshi and Boycott movement.

Q.51. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #15) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following Harappan sites has provided evidence of a ploughed field?
Solution & Rationale: Evidence of a ploughed field with criss-cross furrows was discovered at Kalibangan (Rajasthan). Lothal is famous for its tidal dockyard; Dholavira for water harvesting.

Q.52. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #16) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the following statements regarding Gandhian mass movements is not correct?
Solution & Rationale: Statement (c) is incorrect. Centralized, disciplined leadership and strict moral command were vital hallmarks of all Gandhian campaigns (Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India).

Q.53. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #17) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following statements regarding the spiritual teachings of Guru Nanak Dev, the first Sikh Guru, is correct?
Solution & Rationale: Guru Nanak emphasized universal love, honest labor (Kirat Karo), sharing with others (Vand Chhako), and meditation on the Divine Name (Naam Japna) while rejecting caste prejudices.

Q.54. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #18) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following was the decisive battle in 1760 in which the British forces commanded by Sir Eyre Coote decisively defeated...
Solution & Rationale: The Battle of Wandiwash (22 January 1760) ended French military influence in India and cemented British commercial and political hegemony.

Q.55. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #19) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following was the historic session of the Indian National Congress where the resolution for 'Purna Swaraj' (Co...
Solution & Rationale: At the historic Lahore Session in December 1929, under the presidency of Jawaharlal Nehru, the Indian National Congress adopted the Purna Swaraj resolution declaring complete independence as its ultimate goal.

Q.56. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #20) Correct Response: (C)
*Question Reference: Which one among the following was not a possible reaSon for *the success of Nadir Shah's military campaign in Delhi ?*
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.57. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #21) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Commissions was appointed by the British Government to investigate the Jallianwala Bagh massacre (1919)...
Solution & Rationale: The Hunter Committee (Disorders Inquiry Committee), headed by Lord William Hunter, was appointed in October 1919 to investigate the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in Amritsar.

Q.58. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #22) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following inscriptions mentions Pulakesin II's military success against Harsh avardhana?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

Q.59. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #23) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following statements with respect to Indian Air Force is not correct ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.60. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #24) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following statements regarding the Brihadeeswara Temple at Thanjavur is correct?
Solution & Rationale: Brihadeeswara Temple (Peruvudaiyar Kovil) is a grand Dravidian granite temple dedicated to Lord Shiva, completed in 1010 CE by Rajaraja Chola I.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.61. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #25) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following traditional dance forms is a ritualistic folk dance involving masks made of arecanut spathe, performed ...
Solution & Rationale: Padayani (or Padeni) is an ancient ritualistic folk theater and mask dance performed in Bhadrakali temples of Central Travancore, Kerala.

Q.62. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #26) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Who among the following was elected as the President of the All-India Khilafat Conference met at Delhi in November 1919?
Solution & Rationale: Mahatma Gandhi was elected President of the All-India Khilafat Conference in Delhi in November 1919. He saw the Khilafat movement as a prime opportunity to unite Hindus and Muslims in the national struggle.

Q.63. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #27) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Who among the following led the 1857 Revolt in Bihar?
Solution & Rationale: Veer Kunwar Singh of Jagdishpur (Arrah, Bihar) led the 1857 Revolt in Bihar with exceptional guerrilla warfare tactics at the age of nearly 80.

Q.64. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #28) Correct Response: (D)
Question Reference: Who among the following was not a party to the tripartite confederacy that fought against the British East India Company in the Ba...
Solution & Rationale: Siraj-ud-Daulah fought in the Battle of Plassey (1757) and was killed soon after. The Battle of Buxar (1764) was fought between Hector Munro and the combined forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula, and Shah Alam II.

Q.65. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #29) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following Governors-General of India created the Public Works Department (PWD) and introduced electric telegraph and...
Solution & Rationale: Lord Dalhousie (1848-1856) created the separate Public Works Department (PWD), introduced the first passenger railway (1853, Bombay to Thane), electric telegraph lines, and modern postal system.

Q.66. (Indian History & Freedom Struggle #30) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following eminent Urdu poets and scholars was invited to attend both the Second and Third Round Table Conferences in...
Solution & Rationale: Sir Allama Muhammad Iqbal attended the Second (1931) and Third (1932) Round Table Conferences in London.

SUBJECT 3 : GEOGRAPHY (PHYSICAL, INDIAN & WORLD) (Q.67 - Q.107)

Q.67. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #1) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Arrange the following left-bank tributaries of the River Ganga from West to East in sequential order: 1. Gomti 2. Ghaghara 3. Gand...
Solution & Rationale: From west to east, the major northern Himalayan tributaries joining the Ganga are: Ramganga, Gomti, Ghaghara, Gandak, and Kosi.

Q.68. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #2) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: BrahMos is a supersonic cruise missile developed as a joint venture between India and:
Solution & Rationale: BrahMos (named after the Brahmaputra and Moskva rivers) is a joint venture between India's Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya.

Q.69. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #3) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements regarding the Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ): 1. In the month of July, the ITCZ shifts n...
Solution & Rationale: Both statements are correct: The ITCZ moves northwards towards the Tropic of Cancer in boreal summer, positioning over northern India where it is referred to as the monsoon trough.

Q.70. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #4) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements regarding Iodine in human physiology: 1. Iodine is an essential mineral required by the thyroid ...
Solution & Rationale: Both statements are correct: Iodine is incorporated into thyroxine (T4) and triiodothyronine (T3). Inadequate dietary iodine causes thyroid enlargement (goiter).

Q.71. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #5) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: During the year 2009-2010, which one of the following sectors recorded the highest growth rate in the Indian economy?
Solution & Rationale: According to Economic Survey data for 2009-10, the manufacturing and industrial sectors recorded double-digit expansion following stimulus measures.

Q.72. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #6) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Extrusive volcanoes are not found in
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Geography (Physical, Indian & World) according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.73. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #7) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In which of the following cities is the India Security Press (ISP), which manufactures passports, postage stamps, and judicial sta...
Solution & Rationale: The India Security Press (ISP) is located at Nashik Road, Maharashtra, under SPMCIL. Bank notes are printed at Dewas and Nashik.

Q.74. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #8) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: In which one of the following islands of India is an active volcano found?
Solution & Rationale: Barren Island in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands is the only confirmed active volcano in India and the South Asian subcontinent.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.75. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #9) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In which one of the following cities is the headquarters of the Forest Survey of India (FSI) located?
Solution & Rationale: The Forest Survey of India (FSI), an organization under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change engaged in national forest cover mapping and assessments, is headquartered in Dehradun, Uttarakhand.

Q.76. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #10) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which of the following National Parks of India are declared as World Heritage Sites by UNESCO? 1. Keoladeo National Park 2. Sundar...
Solution & Rationale: Keoladeo National Park (1985), Kaziranga National Park (1985), and Sundarbans National Park (1987) are UNESCO World Heritage Sites. Ranthambore National Park is not inscribed on the World Heritage List.

Q.77. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #11) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Roaring Forties, Furious Fifties, and Shrieking Sixties are terms applied to strong westerly winds found
Solution & Rationale: In the Southern Hemisphere between 40° and 60°S latitude, the lack of landmasses allows the prevailing westerlies to blow with extreme unobstructed velocity, termed Roaring Forties, Furious Fifties, and Shrieking Sixties.

Q.78. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #12) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: The Rohtang Pass, a high mountain pass connecting the Kullu Valley with Lahaul and Spiti, is situated in which Indian state?
Solution & Rationale: Rohtang Pass (elevation 3,978 m) is situated on the eastern Pir Panjal Range in Himachal Pradesh, connecting the Kullu Valley with the Lahaul and Spiti Valleys.

Q.79. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #13) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The supersonic cruise missile 'BrahMos' developed through a joint venture between India and Russia is named after which two rivers...
Solution & Rationale: BrahMos is named as a portmanteau of the Brahmaputra River in India and the Moskva River in Russia.

Q.80. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #14) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Through which of the following states does the Tropic of Cancer (23°30' N) NOT pass in India?
Solution & Rationale: The Tropic of Cancer passes through 8 Indian states: Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura, and Mizoram. It does NOT pass through Odisha.

Q.81. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #15) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: What is the name of the strait where 'Adams' bridge' is situated ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

Q.82. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #16) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: What is the primary characteristic geological feature of the Narmada River Valley?
Solution & Rationale: The Narmada River flows westward through a linear rift valley (fault graben) bounded between the Vindhya Range to the north and the Satpura Range to the south.

Q.83. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #17) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: What was the major international consequence of the Suez Crisis of 1956 following Egypt's nationalization of the canal?
Solution & Rationale: The Suez Crisis forced Britain and France to withdraw under US and UN pressure, accelerating global decolonization and highlighting their displacement by the US and USSR as premier superpowers.

Q.84. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #18) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which among the following regions of India is officially designated as a Global Biodiversity Hotspot?
Solution & Rationale: India contains 4 recognized global biodiversity hotspots: The Himalayas, Indo-Burma, Western Ghats & Sri Lanka, and Sundaland (Nicobar Islands).

Q.85. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #19) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which is the correct arrangement of the following peninsular rivers of India when arranged from North to South?
Solution & Rationale: From north to south: Mahanadi (Chhattisgarh/Odisha) -> Godavari (Maharashtra/AP) -> Krishna (Maharashtra/Karnataka/AP) -> Cauvery (Karnataka/Tamil Nadu).

Q.86. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #20) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which mountain hill range forms the natural physical boundary separating the state of Manipur from the state of Nagaland?
Solution & Rationale: The Barail Range is a tertiary mountain chain that extends across Assam, Nagaland, and Manipur, forming the water divide and physical boundary between Nagaland and Manipur.

Q.87. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #21) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following river basins is known as the 'Sorrow of Bengal'?
Solution & Rationale: The Damodar River was historically known as the 'Sorrow of Bengal' due to frequent catastrophic floods before the construction of the Damodar Valley Corporation (DVC) dams. Kosi is the Sorrow of Bihar.

Q.88. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #22) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following chemical substances dissolves in water with a vigorous evolution of heat (strongly exothermic reaction)?
Solution & Rationale: Reaction of quicklime with water forms slaked lime [CaO + H2O -> Ca(OH)2] and releases large amounts of thermal energy (slaking of lime).

Q.89. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #23) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one among the following animal tissués transports hormones and heat and maintains water balance ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.90. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #24) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following is the geological origin of the Comoros archipelago situated in the northern Mozambique Channel of t...
Solution & Rationale: The Comoros islands are volcanic in origin, formed over an oceanic hot spot. Mount Karthala on Grande Comore is an active shield volcano.

Q.91. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #25) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following was the nationwide anti-corruption citizen movement launched in 2011 advocating the enactment of the...
Solution & Rationale: The 2011 Indian anti-corruption movement, organized primarily under the banner of India Against Corruption (IAC) and spearheaded by Anna Hazare, demanded an independent Lokpal.

Q.92. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #26) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following is the purest natural source of fresh water in the earth's hydrological cycle before touching ground...
Solution & Rationale: Rainwater is the purest form of natural water as it is produced by the natural evaporation-condensation cycle (distillation process) in the atmosphere.

Q.93. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #27) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is the oldest mountain range in India?
Solution & Rationale: The Aravalli Range is one of the oldest fold mountain systems in the world, formed during the Proterozoic eon, now deeply eroded into relict mountains.

Q.94. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #28) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following ocean currents is a cold current
Solution & Rationale: The Benguela Current is a cold ocean current flowing northward along the southwest coast of Africa in the South Atlantic Ocean. Gulf Stream and Brazil Current are warm Atlantic currents; Kuroshio is in the Pacific.

Q.95. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #29) Correct Response: (D)
Question Reference: Which one of the following inland lakes in India has the highest water salinity?
Solution & Rationale: Sambhar Salt Lake in Rajasthan is India's largest inland salt lake and has the highest salinity among Indian inland lakes.

Q.96. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #30) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following States of India is the largest producer of lignite coal?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

Q.97. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #31) Correct Response: (D)
Question Reference: Which one of the following countries is located entirely south of the Equator?
Solution & Rationale: Australia lies entirely in the Southern Hemisphere, well south of the Equator (latitudes 10°S to 43°S). Colombia, Indonesia, and Kenya are all crossed directly by the Equator.

Q.98. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #32) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following trains/ railways passes through Germany, France, Austria, Hungary and Romania?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Geography (Physical, Indian & World)).

Q.99. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #33) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is the correct sequence of the topographical features of a river from its upper course to its lower cou...
Solution & Rationale: Rapids form in the steep upper (youthful) course; meanders and ox-bow lakes form on the flat floodplains of the middle/lower course; estuaries or deltas form where the river meets the sea at its mouth.

Q.100. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #34) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following glycopeptide antibiotics is commonly reserved in clinical practice as the 'drug of last resort' against...
Solution & Rationale: Vancomycin is a powerful glycopeptide antibiotic historically used as a drug of last resort for serious, life-threatening infections caused by Gram-positive bacteria unresponsive to other antibiotics.

Q.101. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #35) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following ocean tides is produced when the Sun, the Moon, and the Earth are aligned in a straight line (syzygy)?
Solution & Rationale: Spring tides occur twice each month (during new moon and full moon) when gravitational pulls of the Sun and Moon reinforce each other in a straight line, producing the highest high tides.

Q.102. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #36) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Indian states has the longest coastline among all peninsular states of mainland India?
Solution & Rationale: Gujarat has the longest mainland coastline in India at approximately 1,600 km, followed by Andhra Pradesh (approx. 974 km).

Q.103. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #37) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is a cold ocean current flowing equatorward along the southwestern coast of the African continent?
Solution & Rationale: The Benguela Current is a prominent cold eastern boundary current of the South Atlantic subtropical gyre flowing north along the coast of Namibia and South Africa.

Q.104. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #38) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following global climate types is characterized by mild, wet winters and warm, dry summers, supporting extensive ...
Solution & Rationale: The Mediterranean climate (Cs in Köppen classification) features dry summers under subtropical high pressure and rainy winters dominated by mid-latitude westerlies, ideal for olives and grapes.

Q.105. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #39) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following major rivers of India flows westward and empties into the Arabian Sea rather than the Bay of Bengal?
Solution & Rationale: The Narmada and Tapti rivers flow westward through tectonic rift valleys and empty into the Arabian Sea via the Gulf of Khambhat. Mahanadi, Godavari, and Cauvery flow eastward into the Bay of Bengal.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.106. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #40) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which type of natural biome is characterized by low temperatures, short growing seasons, permafrost, and dominant vegetation consi...
Solution & Rationale: The Tundra biome is treeless and circumpolar in high northern latitudes. Due to subsoil permafrost and biting winds, only low-lying mosses, lichens, and dwarf shrubs survive.

Q.107. (Geography (Physical, Indian & World) #41) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Who among the following was the founder of the 'Servants of India Society' in 1905?
Solution & Rationale: Gopal Krishna Gokhale founded the Servants of India Society in Pune in 1905 to train national missionaries for the service of India and promote social advancement.

SUBJECT 4 : GENERAL SCIENCE (PHYSICS, CHEMISTRY, BIOLOGY) (Q.108 - Q.163)

Q.108. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #1) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: A female Anopheles mosquito acts as the biological vector for which one of the following diseases?
Solution & Rationale: Female Anopheles mosquitoes transmit Plasmodium parasites causing Malaria. Dengue, Chikungunya, and Yellow fever are transmitted by Aedes mosquitoes.

Q.109. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #2) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: A person suffering from myopia (near-sightedness) is advised to wear lenses of:
Solution & Rationale: Myopia occurs when the eyeball is too elongated or cornea too curved, causing distant rays to focus in front of the retina. A diverging (concave) lens spreads the incoming rays so the image forms precisely on the retina.

Q.110. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #3) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: An object has a mass of 6 kg on the surface of the Earth. When taken to the Moon (where acceleration due to gravity is 1/6th that ...
Solution & Rationale: Mass is an intrinsic property representing the amount of matter in a body and remains constant everywhere (6 kg). Only the weight (W = mg) decreases to 1/6th on the Moon.

Q.111. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #4) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements regarding the Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of the Indian Armed Forces: 1. The CDS functions as t...
Solution & Rationale: Both statements are correct: The CDS is a 4-star General who heads the Department of Military Affairs (DMA), chairs the Chiefs of Staff Committee, and acts as principal military adviser to the Raksha Mantri.

Q.112. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #5) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Down's syndrome, a genetic condition causing developmental and intellectual delays in humans, is caused by which chromosomal abnor...
Solution & Rationale: Down's syndrome is caused by non-disjunction of chromosome 21 during meiosis, resulting in cells having 47 chromosomes instead of 46 (Trisomy 21).

Q.113. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #6) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: For the same rise in temperature, which of the three states of matter undergoes the greatest volumetric thermal expansion?
Solution & Rationale: Gases exhibit the highest coefficient of thermal expansion because intermolecular forces are minimal, allowing particles to move far apart when heated.

Q.114. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #7) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: If excess chemical fertilizer is applied to a potted plant without adding adequate water, the plant wilts and dies because of:
Solution & Rationale: High concentration of fertilizer salts creates a hypertonic external solution around the roots. Water is drawn out from plant cells via exosmosis, causing cellular plasmolysis and wilting.

Q.115. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #8) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In demographic studies and development economics, the Dependency Ratio of a nation is mathematically defined as:
Solution & Rationale: The dependency ratio measures the age-population ratio of typically dependent citizens (under 15 and over 64) relative to the productive working-age population.

Q.116. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #9) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: In the human digestive system, the opening of the stomach into the small intestine (duodenum) is regulated by the:
Solution & Rationale: The pyloric sphincter is a band of smooth muscle at the junction between the pylorus of the stomach and the duodenum of the small intestine that controls the flow of chyme.

Q.117. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #10) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In the light of this statement
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.118. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #11) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Lysosome is formed from which one of the following cell organelles?
Solution & Rationale: Lysosomes are membrane-bound organelles containing digestive enzymes that are packaged and budded off from the Golgi apparatus/bodies.

Q.119. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #12) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The International Court of Justice (ICJ), the principal judicial organ of the United Nations based at The Hague, is composed of ho...
Solution & Rationale: The ICJ consists of 15 judges elected by the UN General Assembly and Security Council for 9-year terms. Five judges are elected every three years.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.120. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #13) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: The Reserve Bank of India has recently constituted a high-level task force on Public Credit Registry (PCR) to suggest a road map f...
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.121. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #14) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The fundamental physical law which explains why a heavy steel ship floats on the ocean while a small iron needle sinks is:
Solution & Rationale: Archimedes' Principle states that a body immersed in a fluid is buoyed up by a force equal to the weight of fluid displaced. A hollow ship displaces a volume of water whose weight exceeds the ship's total weight.

Q.122. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #15) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The human body's primary sensory organ responsible for maintaining balance, posture, and equilibrium is located in the:
Solution & Rationale: The vestibular apparatus in the inner ear, consisting of the three semicircular canals, utricle, and saccule, detects head motion and gravity to maintain balance and equilibrium.

Q.123. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #16) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: The kinetic energy of an object is always conserved.
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.124. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #17) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The natural plant dye Henna (Lawsone) imparts an orange-red stain to human skin and hair by reacting primarily with:
Solution & Rationale: The active colorant in henna is lawsone (hennotannic acid), which binds strongly through Michael addition to keratin proteins found in hair, nails, and the epidermis of the skin.

Q.125. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #18) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Vitamin A ß-carotene ß-carotene Vitamin A engineered 'Golden in
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.126. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #19) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Wavelengths of which of the following colors of the visible light spectrum are maximally absorbed by chlorophyll in green plants f...
Solution & Rationale: Chlorophyll a and b show maximum absorption in the blue (430-450 nm) and red (640-660 nm) regions of the visible spectrum, while reflecting green light (giving plants their green appearance).

Q.127. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #20) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: What is 'heavy water' (D2O) used as in nuclear power reactors?
Solution & Rationale: Heavy water (deuterium oxide, D2O) contains deuterium atoms and is used primarily as a neutron moderator (slowing down fast neutrons) and as a coolant in Pressurized Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs).

Q.128. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #21) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: What is a 'Green Data Centre'?
Solution & Rationale: A green data centre is an enterprise storage repository where lighting, electrical, cooling, and compute systems are engineered to achieve maximum power usage effectiveness (PUE) and minimal carbon emissions.

Q.129. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #22) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: What is that particular tribal group?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.130. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #23) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: What is the minimum mandate of a democratic government ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.131. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #24) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: What is the primary chemical compound that constitutes natural pearls and sea shells?
Solution & Rationale: Pearls and mollusk shells consist primarily of calcium carbonate (CaCO3, mostly in the form of aragonite crystals) deposited in concentric layers held together by the organic protein conchiolin.

Q.132. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #25) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which among the following are the two primary raw materials used in the saponification process to manufacture soap?
Solution & Rationale: Soap is produced by saponification, the alkaline hydrolysis of triglycerides (vegetable oils or animal fats) with a strong base such as sodium hydroxide (caustic soda) or potassium hydroxide.

Q.133. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #26) Correct Response: (C)
*Question Reference: Which among the following oils has the maximum protein *content ?*
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.134. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #27) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which cell organelle is famously known as the 'Powerhouse of the Cell' due to ATP production?
Solution & Rationale: Mitochondria produce adenosine triphosphate (ATP) through cellular respiration and oxidative phosphorylation, thereby serving as the powerhouse of eukaryotic cells. Lysosomes are suicide bags.

Q.135. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #28) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following statements relating to the Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) is/are correct? 1. It was founded to maintain indepen...
Solution & Rationale: Statement 1 is correct: NAM originated at the 1955 Bandung Conference and 1961 Belgrade Summit. Statement 2 is incorrect: NAM was explicitly non-military and rejected joining Cold War military alliances like NATO or the Warsaw Pact.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.136. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #29) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following noble gases is present in the highest abundance by volume in dry atmospheric air?
Solution & Rationale: Argon is the third most abundant gas in dry air (approx. 0.934% by volume). Other noble gases like Neon (0.0018%), Helium (0.0005%), and Krypton (0.0001%) are trace elements.

Q.137. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #30) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the following statements regarding the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act (AFSPA) is not correct?
Solution & Rationale: AFSPA cannot be invoked arbitrarily by district magistrates; an area must be formally declared a 'disturbed area' by the Central Government, Governor, or UT Administrator under Section 3 of the Act.

Q.138. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #31) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following infectious diseases is caused by a protozoan parasite and transmitted by the bite of the sandfly?
Solution & Rationale: Kala-azar (Visceral leishmaniasis) is caused by the protozoan parasite Leishmania donovani and transmitted to humans by the bite of infected female phlebotomine sandflies.

Q.139. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #32) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following chemical compounds exhibits electrovalent (ionic) bonding rather than covalent bonding?
Solution & Rationale: Calcium chloride (CaCl2) is an ionic compound formed between a metal (calcium) and non-metal (chlorine) by complete transfer of electrons. CH4, CCl4, and NH3 are covalent compounds.

Q.140. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #33) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following pairs of international judicial or financial organizations and their headquarters is correctly matched?
Solution & Rationale: The ICJ is headquartered at the Peace Palace in The Hague, Netherlands. IMF and World Bank are in Washington, D.C.; WTO is in Geneva.

Q.141. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #34) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one among the following natural or artificial processes produces light through a chemical reaction (chemiluminescence)?
Solution & Rationale: Fireflies produce light through bioluminescence, a form of chemiluminescence where the pigment luciferin is oxidized in the presence of the enzyme luciferase and ATP without producing heat.

Q.142. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #35) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following substances is lipid-soluble and absorbed directly and rapidly across the epithelial lining of the hu...
Solution & Rationale: Unlike most foods which require enzymatic digestion and are absorbed in the small intestine, ethanol is lipid-soluble and can be directly absorbed through the gastric mucosa of the stomach.

Q.143. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #36) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one among the following was developed as an indigenous high-performance supercomputer by the Indian Space Research Organisat...
Solution & Rationale: SAGA-220 (Supercomputer for Aerospace with GPU Architecture-220 teraflops) was built by ISRO at the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC) using commercial off-the-shelf GPU hardware.

Q.144. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #37) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following metals is stored in kerosene oil to prevent it from reacting with atmospheric moisture and oxygen?
Solution & Rationale: Sodium and potassium are highly reactive alkali metals that react violently and exothermically with water and oxygen at room temperature, releasing combustible hydrogen. They are safely preserved immersed in kerosene.

Q.145. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #38) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following gases is responsible for the effervescence observed when baking soda is added to vinegar?
Solution & Rationale: When sodium bicarbonate (baking soda, NaHCO3) reacts with acetic acid (vinegar, CH3COOH), sodium acetate, water, and carbon dioxide (CO2) gas are produced. The rapid release of CO2 produces vigorous effervescence.

Q.146. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #39) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following elements is essential for the formation of chlorophyll in green plants?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.147. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #40) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following places of India experiences highest atmospheric pressure during winter?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.148. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #41) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is an object with such a strong gravitational field that even light cannot escape from its surface?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.149. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #42) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following human diseases is caused by a protozoan parasite and NOT by bacteria or viruses?
Solution & Rationale: Malaria is caused by the protozoan Plasmodium (transmitted by female Anopheles mosquito). Tetanus is bacterial; Measles and Mumps are viral diseases.

Q.150. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #43) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is India's indigenously designed and built single-engine supersonic Light Combat Aircraft (LCA)?
Solution & Rationale: LCA Tejas is an indigenous single-engine, delta-wing multirole light fighter aircraft designed by the Aeronautical Development Agency (ADA) and manufactured by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL).

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.151. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #44) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following metals cannot be used as a sacrificial anode ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.152. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #45) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following chemical compounds is widely used as a mordant in the textile dyeing and leather tanning industries?
Solution & Rationale: Potash alum (potassium aluminum sulfate) acts as a mordant by providing aluminum ions that bind natural dyes to textile fibers, fixing colors permanently.

Q.153. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #46) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following pairs of Indian military training academies and their locations is correctly matched?
Solution & Rationale: NDA is in Khadakwasla (Pune); IMA is in Dehradun; OTA is in Chennai/Gaya; INA is in Ezhimala (Kerala).

Q.154. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #47) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following deficiencies is most frequently responsible for anemia in India ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.155. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #48) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following viral diseases is transmitted to humans by the bite of the female Aedes aegypti mosquito?
Solution & Rationale: Aedes aegypti mosquitoes transmit Dengue, Chikungunya, Zika, and Yellow fever. Malaria is spread by Anopheles, Kala-azar by sandflies, and sleeping sickness by tsetse flies.

Q.156. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #49) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following alloys is commonly used for making heating elements in electrical appliances like heaters and electric ...
Solution & Rationale: Nichrome (an alloy of 80% nickel and 20% chromium) has high electrical resistivity and a high melting point, and does not easily oxidize at high temperatures.

Q.157. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #50) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following synthetic chemical compounds is widely used by farmers as a selective systemic herbicide to destroy bro...
Solution & Rationale: 2,4-D is a synthetic auxin herbicide that selectively eliminates dicotyledonous (broadleaf) weeds without harming monocotyledonous grasses (wheat, corn, rice).

Q.158. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #51) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following parameters will remain constant during the fall ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.159. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #52) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following physical properties decreases systematically as one moves from left to right across a period in the Per...
Solution & Rationale: Atomic radius decreases across a period from left to right due to increased effective nuclear charge pulling valence electrons closer to the nucleus.

Q.160. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #53) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following statements about the commonly used automobile battery are true? 1. It is usually a lead-acid battery. 2. It...
Solution & Rationale: A standard 12V car battery consists of six 2V lead-acid cells connected in series. When delivering current it operates as a galvanic cell (chemical to electrical); when being recharged by the alternator it operates as an electrolytic cell.

Q.161. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #54) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is responsible for the stimulating effect of tea?
Solution & Rationale: The stimulating effect of tea is primarily due to the purine alkaloid caffeine (also known as theine), which acts as a central nervous system stimulant.

Q.162. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #55) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following statements about the commonly used automobile battery are true? 1. It is usually a lead-acid battery. 2. It...
Solution & Rationale: A standard 12V car battery consists of six 2V lead-acid cells connected in series. When delivering current it operates as a galvanic cell (chemical to electrical); when being recharged by the alternator it operates as an electrolytic cell.

Q.163. (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) #56) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is responsible for the stimulating effect of tea?
Solution & Rationale: The stimulating effect of tea is primarily due to the purine alkaloid caffeine (also known as theine), which acts as a central nervous system stimulant.

SUBJECT 5 : INDIAN ECONOMY & SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT (Q.164 - Q.183)

Q.164. (Indian Economy & Social Development #1) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Fiscal Deficit in the Union Budget of India is defined as:
Solution & Rationale: Fiscal Deficit = Total Budget Expenditure - Total Receipts excluding borrowings. It represents the total borrowing requirements of the government from all sources.

Q.165. (Indian Economy & Social Development #2) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: In which year did the Constituent Assembly of Nepal formally declare the country a Federal Democratic Republic, thereby ending the...
Solution & Rationale: On 28 May 2008, the newly elected Constituent Assembly of Nepal voted overwhelmingly to abolish the monarchy and declare Nepal a Federal Democratic Republic.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.166. (Indian Economy & Social Development #3) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Primary Deficit in public finance is mathematically computed by deducting which one of the following from the Fiscal Deficit?
Solution & Rationale: Primary Deficit = Fiscal Deficit - Interest Payments. It indicates government borrowing requirements strictly to finance ongoing fiscal policies excluding past debt obligations.

Q.167. (Indian Economy & Social Development #4) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Special Drawing Rights (SDRs), also known as 'paper gold', are supplementary foreign exchange reserve assets created by:
Solution & Rationale: SDRs were created by the IMF in 1969 to supplement member countries' official reserves. The SDR basket includes the US Dollar, Euro, Chinese Renminbi, Japanese Yen, and British Pound.

Q.168. (Indian Economy & Social Development #5) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The Goods and Services Tax (GST) was introduced in India through which Constitutional Amendment Act?
Solution & Rationale: The 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016 introduced Article 246A and Article 279A, establishing the Goods and Services Tax (GST) regime in India with effect from 1 July 2017.

Q.169. (Indian Economy & Social Development #6) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The Lorenz Curve in economics is a graphical representation used to measure:
Solution & Rationale: The Lorenz Curve plots cumulative percentage of population against cumulative percentage of income earned. The Gini Coefficient is derived directly from the area between the line of equality and the Lorenz Curve.

Q.170. (Indian Economy & Social Development #7) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The Phillips Curve in macroeconomic theory illustrates an inverse relationship between:
Solution & Rationale: The Phillips Curve, formulated by A.W. Phillips in 1958, shows an empirical inverse relationship between the rate of unemployment and the rate of inflation in an economy.

Q.171. (Indian Economy & Social Development #8) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: The above statements are true of
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.172. (Indian Economy & Social Development #9) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The concept of 'Gross National Happiness' (GNH) as a measure of national development progress was first introduced by which countr...
Solution & Rationale: Gross National Happiness (GNH) was instituted in 1972 by Jigme Singye Wangchuck, the 4th King of Bhutan, measuring social development and environmental conservation alongside economics.

Q.173. (Indian Economy & Social Development #10) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: The difference between total revenue expenditure and total revenue receipts of the government in a financial year is called:
Solution & Rationale: Revenue Deficit = Revenue Expenditure - Revenue Receipts. It signifies that the government is borrowing to finance its day-to-day administrative consumption expenditure.

Q.174. (Indian Economy & Social Development #11) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Under Section 8(1) of the Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005, which of the following categories of information is exempt from pu...
Solution & Rationale: Section 8(1)(a) explicitly exempts information whose disclosure would prejudicially affect the sovereignty and integrity of India, state security, strategy, scientific or economic interests.

Q.175. (Indian Economy & Social Development #12) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: What was the target deadline year set by the United Nations for achieving the eight Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) adopted in...
Solution & Rationale: The Millennium Development Goals (MDGs) established eight anti-poverty and development goals with measurable targets to be achieved by the year 2015, succeeded by the 2030 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Q.176. (Indian Economy & Social Development #13) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following macroeconomic policy measures is typically adopted by monetary and fiscal authorities to curb high inflatio...
Solution & Rationale: To tame inflation (contractionary policy), central banks hike interest rates (repo rate) to tighten liquidity and credit, while the government reduces public spending and fiscal deficits.

Q.177. (Indian Economy & Social Development #14) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following statements regarding India's highest civilian award, the Bharat Ratna, is correct?
Solution & Rationale: There is no formal requirement that the recipient must be an Indian citizen. Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (1987) and Nelson Mandela (1990) received the Bharat Ratna.

Q.178. (Indian Economy & Social Development #15) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following rates is known as the key policy interest rate at which the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lends short-term li...
Solution & Rationale: The Repo Rate (Repurchase Option Rate) is the benchmark interest rate at which the RBI lends money to commercial banks against pledged government collateral.

Q.179. (Indian Economy & Social Development #16) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following is NOT included while calculating the Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of India?
Solution & Rationale: Transfer payments are unilateral payments made without any corresponding exchange of goods or services in return, and are therefore excluded from GDP calculations.

Q.180. (Indian Economy & Social Development #17) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following institutions publishes the annual 'World Economic Outlook' (WEO) report?
Solution & Rationale: The World Economic Outlook is a survey published biannually by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) analyzing global economic trends and GDP growth forecasts.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.181. (Indian Economy & Social Development #18) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Indian states shares an international land border with three countries (Nepal, Bhutan, and China)?
Solution & Rationale: Sikkim shares international borders with three countries: Nepal to the west, China (Tibet Autonomous Region) to the north/northeast, and Bhutan to the east.

Q.182. (Indian Economy & Social Development #19) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following public sector banks in India historically had an emblem featuring a dog with the motto 'Faithful, Frien...
Solution & Rationale: Syndicate Bank, established in 1925 in Manipal, Karnataka, was famously known for its symbol of a faithful dog and the tagline 'Faithful, Friendly'. It was amalgamated into Canara Bank in 2020.

Q.183. (Indian Economy & Social Development #20) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following indices is currently used as the headline measure of inflation by the Reserve Bank of India for monetar...
Solution & Rationale: Following the recommendations of the Urjit Patel Committee in 2014, the RBI officially adopted Consumer Price Index - Combined (CPI-C, base year 2012) for inflation targeting (4% +/- 2%).

SUBJECT 6 : DEFENCE, SECURITY & CURRENT AFFAIRS (Q.184 - Q.239)

Q.184. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #1) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: According to the law of diminishing marginal utility, as the amount of a good consumed increases, the marginal utility of that goo...
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.185. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #2) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: According to the official Census of India, which one among the following Indian States has consistently recorded the highest femal...
Solution & Rationale: Kerala ranks highest in overall literacy and female literacy in India (over 92% female literacy).

Q.186. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #3) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: According to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) noise standards in India, what is the permissible ambient noise level in a...
Solution & Rationale: CPCB noise limits for residential zones are 55 dB(A) Leq during daytime (6 AM to 10 PM) and 45 dB(A) Leq during nighttime.

Q.187. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #4) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements regarding the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS): 1. It is a consultative maritime security ini...
Solution & Rationale: Both statements are correct: IONS was initiated by the Indian Navy in February 2008 to enhance maritime cooperation and interoperability among Indian Ocean littoral states.

Q.188. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #5) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements regarding the Indian Coast Guard (ICG): 1. It functions under the Ministry of Defence. 2. It is ...
Solution & Rationale: The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) was established on 1 February 1977 and functions under the Ministry of Defence, mandated with safeguarding India's maritime zones, EEZ surveillance, and search and rescue.

Q.189. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #6) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: From which part of the plant is it obtained ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.190. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #7) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: If the door of a running refrigerator in a closed room is kept open, what' will be the net effect on the room ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.191. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #8) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: In the context of elections in India
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.192. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #9) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: In which North African country did the popular pro-democracy uprisings known as the 'Arab Spring' originate in December 2010?
Solution & Rationale: The Arab Spring started in Tunisia in December 2010 following the self-immolation of Mohamed Bouazizi, leading to the Jasmine Revolution and spreading across North Africa and the Middle East.

Q.193. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #10) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: In which one of the following types of connective tissues in animals does fat get stored?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.194. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #11) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: In which one of the following pair of states has the Indian Army launched "Operation Good Samaritan" ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.195. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #12) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements about the National Wildlife Action Plan (NWAP) of India for 2017-2031: 1. This is the Third Nati...
Solution & Rationale: The NWAP 2017-2031 is India's 3rd National Wildlife Action Plan. It is notable for integrating climate change impacts into wildlife planning for the first time. It has 17 priority themes and 103 conservation actions.

Q.196. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #13) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Consider the following statements about the National Wildlife Action Plan (NWAP) of India for 2017-2031: 1. This is the Third Nati...
Solution & Rationale: The NWAP 2017-2031 is India's 3rd National Wildlife Action Plan. It is notable for integrating climate change impacts into wildlife planning for the first time. It has 17 priority themes and 103 conservation actions.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.197. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #14) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: The Western Naval Command of the Indian Navy is headquartered at:
Solution & Rationale: The Western Naval Command is headquartered in Mumbai (Maharashtra). The Eastern Naval Command is at Visakhapatnam (Andhra Pradesh), and the Southern Naval Command (Training) is at Kochi (Kerala).

Q.198. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #15) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: The boundary line between India and China is known as:
Solution & Rationale: The McMahon Line was negotiated between Tibet and Great Britain at the 1914 Simla Convention, defining the boundary between Arunachal Pradesh (India) and Tibet/China.

Q.199. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #16) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: This feature enables them to resemble with
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.200. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #17) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: To which property of the appliance is this related ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.201. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #18) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: What are the methods; adopted by civil society activists ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.202. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #19) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: What is the name of the literary genre developed by the Khojas who are a branch of the Ismaili sect?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.203. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #20) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: What is the name of the satellite?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.204. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #21) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which gne of the following states does not have Vidhan Parishad ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.205. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #22) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the above statements is/ are correct ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.206. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #23) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following historical warships was the first aircraft carrier of the Indian Navy, commissioned in 1961 and playing a d...
Solution & Rationale: INS Vikrant (formerly HMS Hercules) was India's first aircraft carrier, commissioned in 1961. Her Sea Hawk aircraft played a heroic role during the 1971 Liberation War in East Pakistan.

Q.207. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #24) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which of the following represents a relation for lieat lost = heat gained'?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.208. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #25) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which of the following classes of animals has/have three-chambered heart?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.209. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #26) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the following sprinter won three gold medals and set world records in 100m, 200m, and 4x100m relay at the 2008 Beijing Ol...
Solution & Rationale: Usain Bolt dominated the 2008 Beijing Olympics with historic world record gold medal performances across sprinting events.

Q.210. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #27) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.211. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #28) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.212. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #29) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the statements given are correct ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.213. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #30) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which of the statements given above islare correct ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.214. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #31) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the statements given is/ are correct ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.215. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #32) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?*
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.216. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #33) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one among the following is NOT one of the Baltic States of Northeastern Europe?
Solution & Rationale: The three Baltic states on the eastern coast of the Baltic Sea are Estonia, Latvia, and Lithuania. Slovakia is a landlocked Central European nation.

Q.217. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #34) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one among the following creeks is not associated with the state of Gujarat ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.218. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #35) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following was historically designated as the longest National Highway in India connecting Varanasi to Kanyakumari...
Solution & Rationale: Under the old national highway numbering system, NH 7 (2,369 km) connecting Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh to Kanyakumari in Tamil Nadu was the longest highway in India (now part of NH 44).

Q.219. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #36) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following crops is not cultivated in Karewas, the lacustrine deposit's of sand, clay, loam, silt and boulders?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.220. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #37) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Which one of the following became a part of China in 1997 following the principle of 'one country, two systems'?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.221. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #38) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is the correct order of the layers of the Earth's atmosphere starting from the surface upwards?
Solution & Rationale: From ground to space: Troposphere (0-12 km), Stratosphere (12-50 km, contains ozone layer), Mesosphere (50-85 km), Thermosphere (85-600 km), and Exosphere.

Q.222. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #39) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following statements regarding the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is NOT correct?
Solution & Rationale: The permanent Secretariat of ASEAN is located in Jakarta, Indonesia, not Singapore.

Q.223. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #40) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following statements regarding the Association of South East Asian Nations (ASEAN) is not correct ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.224. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #41) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following Southeast Asian countries shares a land border with both India and China and acts as a gateway for Indi...
Solution & Rationale: Myanmar borders four northeast Indian states (Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram) and also shares borders with China, Laos, Thailand, and Bangladesh.

Q.225. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #42) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is not a result of surface tension ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.226. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #43) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following polymeric materials is used for making bulletproof jacket ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.227. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #44) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is NOT an association football (soccer) tournament in India?
Solution & Rationale: The Irani Cup is a first-class cricket tournament played between the Ranji Trophy champion team and the Rest of India team.

Q.228. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #45) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following measures would not be Sustainable in this respect ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.229. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #46) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of the following is the correct sequence of the given tiger reserves of India from north to south ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.230. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #47) Correct Response: (C)
Question Reference: Which one of thy following company has recently acquired mobile service oierätiöns in countries from Zairi ?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.231. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #48) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Who among the following is the winner of the National Badminton Championship (Men), 2017?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.232. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #49) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following created a world record in the men's 100 metres sprint event at the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games?
Solution & Rationale: Jamaica's Usain Bolt set a world record of 9.69 seconds to win gold in the men's 100m final at the 2008 Beijing Olympics.

Q.233. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #50) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following won the men's singles title at Wimbledon 2008, defeating Roger Federer in an epic five-set final?
Solution & Rationale: Rafael Nadal won his maiden Wimbledon title in 2008 in a historic match widely considered one of the greatest tennis finals in history.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -

Q.234. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #51) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following was elected as the permanent President of the Constituent Assembly of India on 11 December 1946?
Solution & Rationale: Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha served as temporary chairman on 9 Dec 1946; on 11 Dec 1946, Dr. Rajendra Prasad was unanimously elected permanent President of the Constituent Assembly.

Q.235. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #52) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following cricket legends holds the world record for the fastest century in Men's One Day International (ODI) cricke...
Solution & Rationale: South Africa's AB de Villiers scored a hundred off 31 deliveries against the West Indies in Johannesburg in January 2015.

Q.236. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #53) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following was known as the 'Iron Man of India' and served as the first Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister of in...
Solution & Rationale: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel orchestrated the integration of over 560 princely states into the Indian Union, earning the title 'Iron Man of India' and 'Bismarck of India'.

Q.237. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #54) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following legendary musicians and playback singers from Assam was posthumously conferred the Bharat Ratna in 2019?
Solution & Rationale: Dr. Bhupen Hazarika, the legendary singer, lyricist, and composer known as the 'Bard of Brahmaputra', was posthumously awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2019.

Q.238. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #55) Correct Response: (A)
Question Reference: Who among the following legendary cinematographers, famed for his black-and-white visual mastery in Guru Dutt classics like 'Pyaas...
Solution & Rationale: V. K. Murthy was the first cinematographer in Indian cinema history to receive the prestigious Dadasaheb Phalke Award (conferred in 2008).

Q.239. (Defence, Security & Current Affairs #56) Correct Response: (B)
Question Reference: Who deciphered the Brahmi and Kharoshthi scripts?
Solution & Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Defence, Military & Current Affairs according to UPSC CDS standards.

- SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK -